Announcements

- Last lecture today
- There is an in-class activity today based on the topic
- I will discuss project 2 final deliverables

CS3300 A Introduction to Software Engineering

Lecture 18: Code Smells

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Slides adapted from Alessandro Orso

Refactoring discussed last lecture..



Program Refactored Program

Small, independent techniques to apply transformations to a program, with the goal of improving its design without changing its functionality

Goal: Keep program readable, understandable, and maintainable. Avoid small problems soon.

Key Feature: Behavior Preserving- make sure the program works after each step; typically small steps

How to know code needs Refactoring/Indicators of Problems in code : Code Smells

What is a Code Smell?

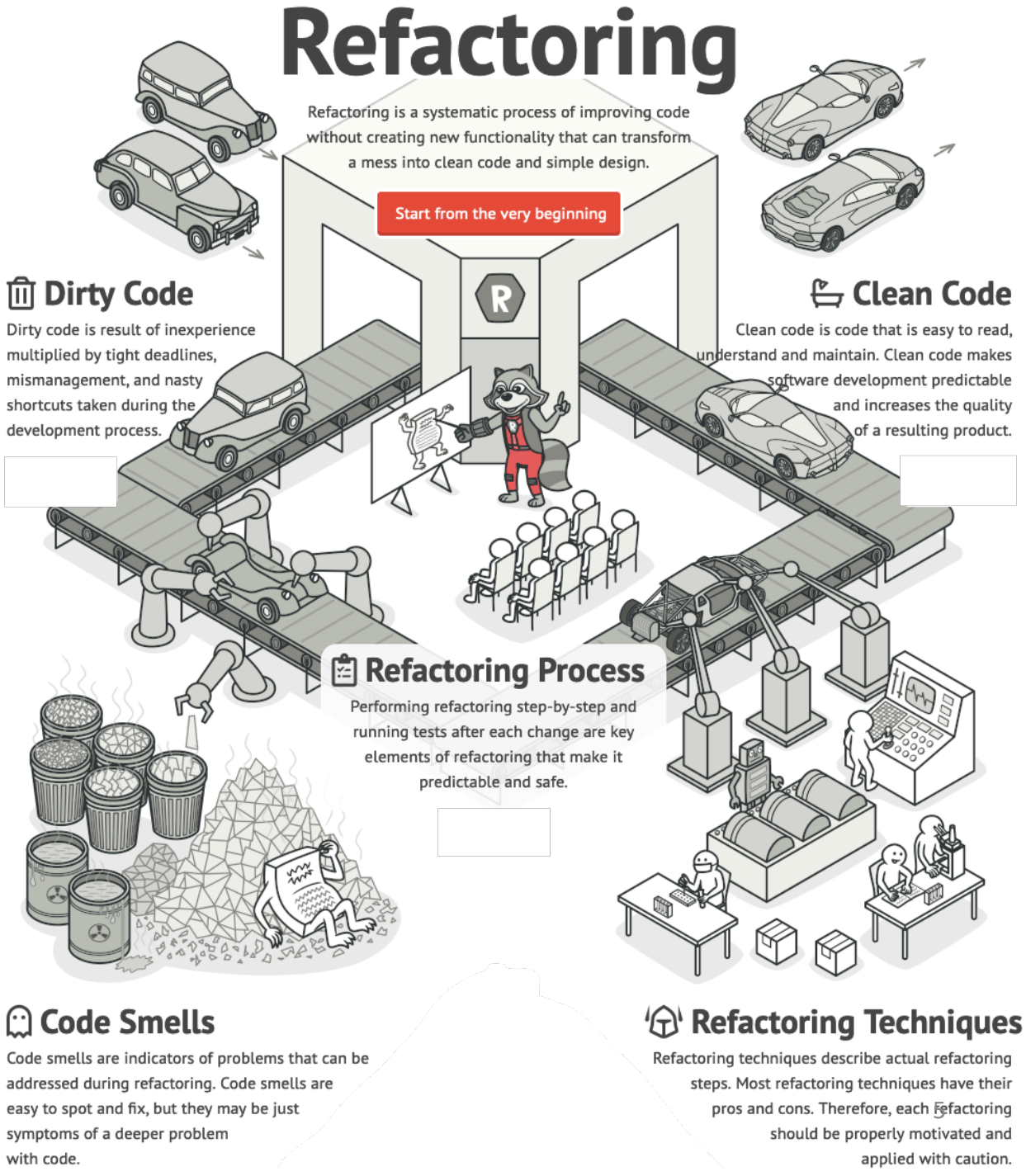
- Martin Fowler: "*a code smell is a surface indication that usually corresponds to a deeper problem in the system*"
  - Something that is quick to spot
  - Indicator of a bigger problem with your code

- Generally, you find code smells when examining the code, or doing refactoring

Refactoring and Code Smells

Refactoring is a systematic process of improving code without creating new functionality that can transform a mess into clean code and simple design.

Code Smells help us find the problems



https://refactoring.guru/refactoring

Why Code Smells Matter Today

Code smells signal maintainability risks—even when the code works.

Common code smell	Why it matters	Possible refactoring
Long methods / large classes	Difficult to understand and modify	Extract Method / Class
Duplicated code	Changes must be repeated in multiple places	Extract Method
Complex conditionals	Harder to understand and test all paths	Decompose Conditional
Tight coupling	Changes in one class affect others	Move Method / Extract Class

With AI-assisted development

- AI can generate working code quickly, but may introduce duplication or unnecessary complexity.
- AI can also identify smells and suggest refactorings; engineers review changes and verify behavior.

Code Smell: Summary

Group name	Short description	Smells in group	Treatment/Refactoring
Bloaters	something that has grown so large that it cannot be effectively handled.	-Long method -Large class -Long parameter list -Data clumps	-Extract Method -Extract class -Replace parameters with method call/object - Preserve whole object
Object-Orientation Abusers	cases where the solution does not fully exploit the possibilities of object-oriented design.	-Switch statements -Refused Bequest (inheritance is being abused)	-Use polymorphism -Push down method/-Eliminate inheritance
Change Preventers	smells that hinder changing or further developing the software.	-Divergent Change -Shotgun surgery	-Extract Class, Method -Move methods and fields
Dispensables	represent something unnecessary that should be removed from the source code.	-Lazy class -Data class -Duplicated code	-Inline class -Move method/Extract Method/Encapsulation -Extract Method
Couplers	a measure of how closely connected two routines or modules are	-Feature envy -Inappropriate intimacy -Middle man	-Move method/field -Bidirectional to unidirectional association -Inline Class

Refactoring Safely with AI

A practical workflow for reviewing AI-generated changes

1. Identify a specific code smell or maintenance problem
2. Run regression tests and establish baseline behavior
3. Ask AI for a small, targeted refactoring
4. Inspect the diff for scope creep or changed behavior
5. Rerun tests and static analysis; accept or revise

Work on the code smell activity

Project 2 Grading: 30% of Your Course Grade

Seven team deliverables and two individual ones; CATME peer evaluations can adjust your individual share

Deliverable	Graded as	Points	Due
Topic & MMFs (mentor check-in)	Team	30	Oct 23 (done)
Agentic AI Workflow Report	Team	20	Nov 15
AI Integration in Testing	Team	100	Nov 22
Code + customer delivery document (GitHub)	Team	50	Dec 2
Code Review: pull requests	**Individual**	9	Dec 2
Presentation & Demo	Team	200	Dec 2 or Dec 4
Implementation Interview	**Individual**	50	Dec 5–8
Report (GitHub Pages)	Team	200	Dec 8
Audience Participation	Team	30	Dec 8

Also due Dec 8: CATME post-Project 2 peer evaluation. Extra credit: up to +30 points on Presentation & Demo (see next slide).

Presentation & Demo: Dec 2 and Dec 4

5 minutes + 1 minute Q&A per team · upload Presentation_Project2_TeamXX.pdf before the first demo on Dec 2

Intro
1 min

AI tools, agentic workflow & design patterns
1 min

Live demo on GCP
3 min

Your demo and slides must show

- All 4 MMFs working end to end (login doesn't count)
- Deployed on Google Cloud
- At least 1 AI tool used in implementation
- Your bounded agentic workflow
- At least 3 design patterns, justified
- AI tools in both black-box and white-box testing

Also counts

Audience participation (30 pts): one teammate in class asks every team a question via the form; your team answers all questions you received, PDF due Dec 8

Extra credit (up to +30): more than 4 MMFs (+10), innovative AI testing (+10), Docker (+5), AI survey or extensive automated black-box testing (+5)

Individual Implementation Interview: Dec 5–8

An Honorlock Canvas quiz worth 50 points: you explain your own team's project out loud

How it works

- **Open notes, open tabs:** repo, deployed app, report, your notes
- **Speak your answers** while showing the code; type the file paths
    - 5 questions
- **Not allowed:** AI tools or help from anyone
- **Recorded:** webcam, mic and screen, reviewed by your mentor

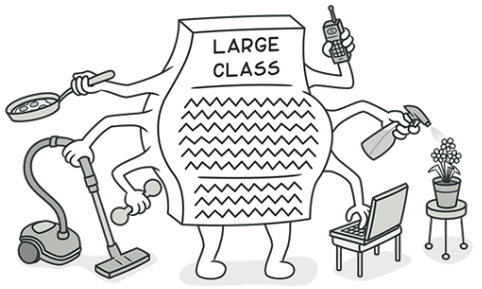
Bloaters

Large Classes, Long Methods, Data Clumps, and Long Parameter List



https://refactoring.guru/refactoring/smells

Bloaters: **Large Class**



Signs/Symptoms

A class contains many fields/methods/lines of code. May have duplicated code.

Reasons

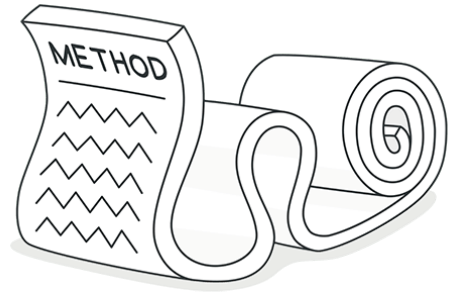
Developers may find it mentally less taxing to place a new feature in an existing class than to create a new class for the feature.

Treatment

Extract Class, Extract Subclass, Extract Method

https://refactoring.guru/smells/large-class

Bloaters: **Long Method**



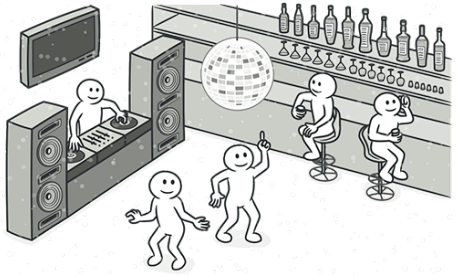
Signs/Symptoms

- A method contains too many lines of code. Generally, any method longer than ten lines should make you start asking questions.
- Conditional operators and loops are a good clue that code can be moved to a separate method
- A block of code with a comment that tells you what it is doing can be replaced by a method

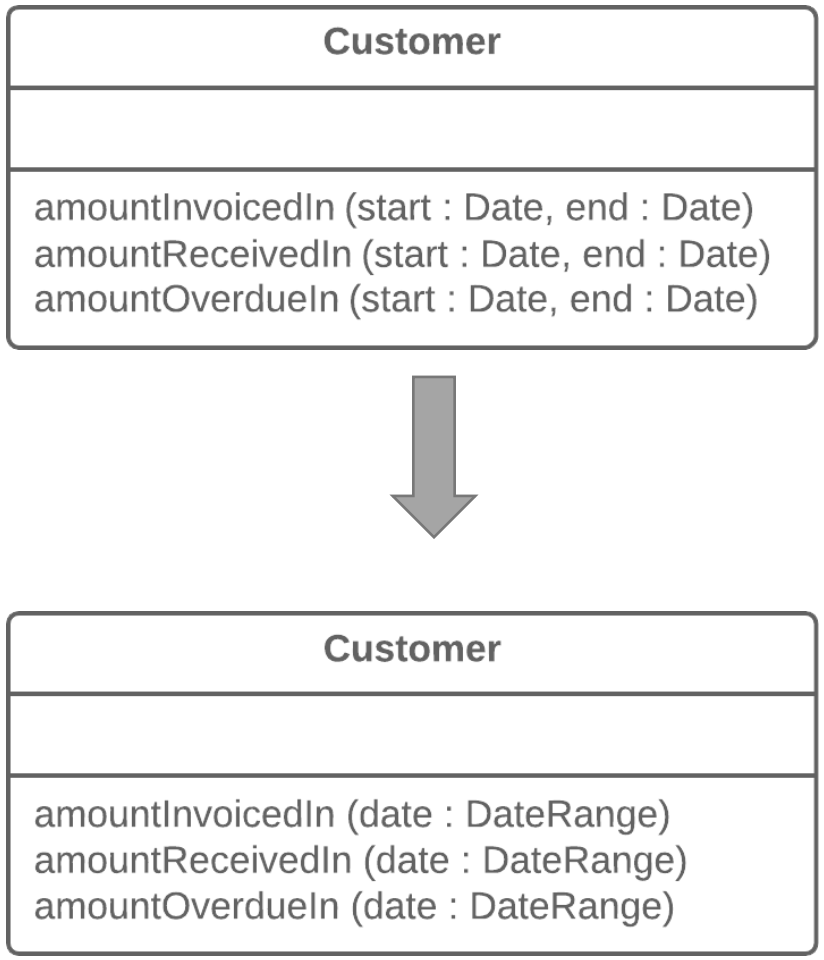
Treatment

- Extract Method

Bloaters: **Data Clumps**



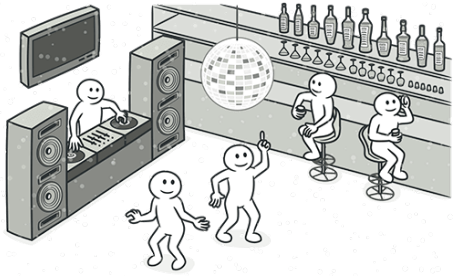
- Sometimes different parts of the code contain identical groups of variables called clumps. (e.g., 3 integers for RGB colors).
- Since these data items are not encapsulated in a class, this increases the sizes of methods and classes.
- To test for this, delete one of the values and see if the others still make sense.



<u>Treatment</u>

- If these variables are passed as parameters, **replace them with an object**
- **Extract Class**

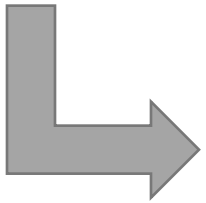
Bloaters: **Data Clumps**



```
class DateUtil {
    boolean isAfter(int year1, int month1, int day1, int year2, int month2, int day2) {
        // implementation
    }

    int differenceInDays(int year1, int month1, int day1, int year2, int month2, int day2) {
        // implementation
    }

    // other date methods
}
```



```
class Date {
    int year;
    int month;
    int day;
}

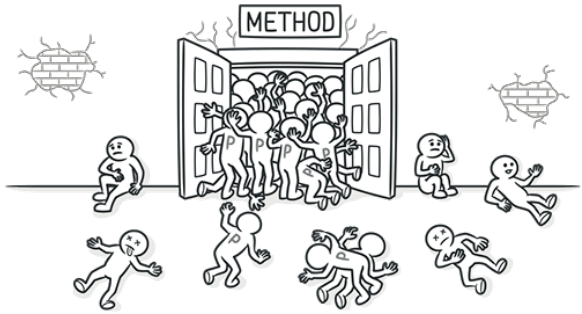
class DateUtil {
    boolean isAfter(Date date1, Date date2) {
        // implementation
    }

    int differenceInDays(Date date1, Date date2) {
        // implementation
    }

    // other date methods
}
```

https://www.baeldung.com/cs/code-smells

Bloaters: Long Parameter List



Signs/Symptoms

- More than three or four parameters for a method
- Hard to understand such lists

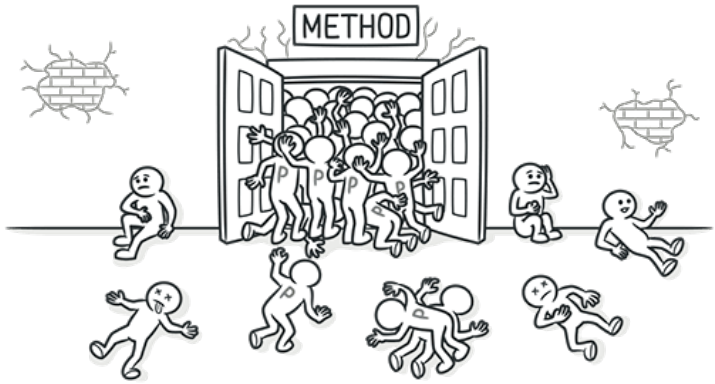
Reasons

- Several types of algorithm are merged in a single method
- A long list may have been created to control which algorithm (or path) is run

Treatment

- Breakup the algorithm
- **Replace Parameters with Method Call**.
- Instead of passing a group of data received from another object as parameters, pass the object itself to the method, by using **Preserve Whole Object**.

Bloaters: **Long Parameter List**



- You get several values from an object and then pass them as parameters to a method.
- Instead, try passing the whole object.

Long parameter lists:

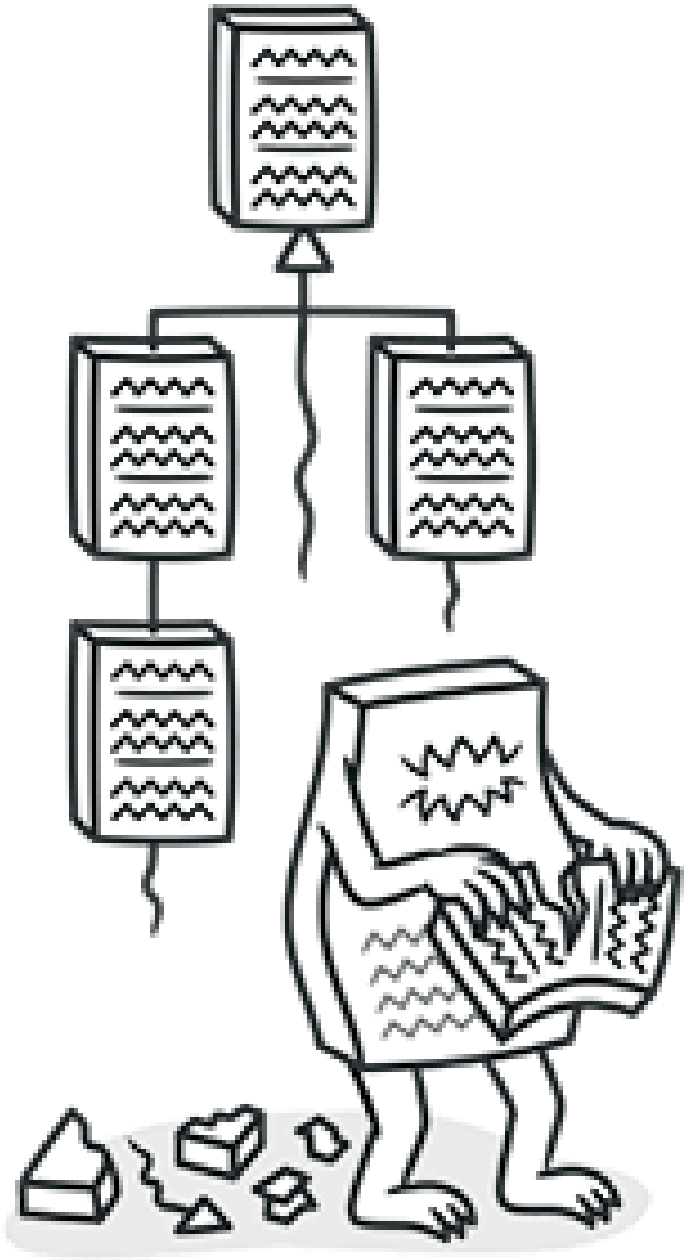
```
function createUser(name, email, phone, address, city, state,
country, zipcode) {
  // ...
}
```

Summary: Bloaters

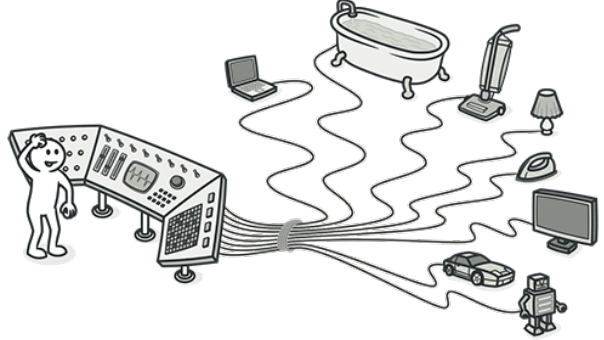
Group name	Short description	Smells in group	Treatment
Bloaters	something that has grown so large that it cannot be effectively handled.	-Long method -Large class -Long parameter list -Data clumps	-Extract Method -Extract class/subclass -Replace parameters with method call/preserve object - Replace with object/Extract Class

OO Abusers

Switch Statements, Refused bequest



OO Abusers: **Switch Statements**



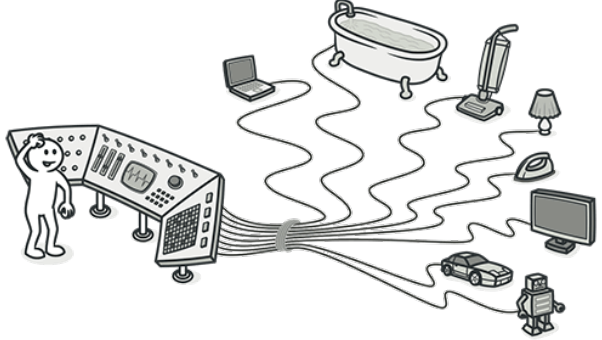
- You have a complex switch operator or sequence of if statements.

Relatively rare use of switch and case operators is one of the hallmarks of object-oriented code.

<u>Treatment</u>

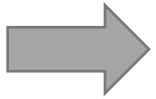
- Extract and Move Method
- Use polymorphism to control implementation (method override)

OO Abusers: **Switch Statements**



```java
class Animal {
    String type;

    String makeSound() {
        switch (type) {
            case "cat":
                return "meow";
            case "dog":
                return "woof";
            default:
                throw new IllegalStateException();
        }
    }
}
```



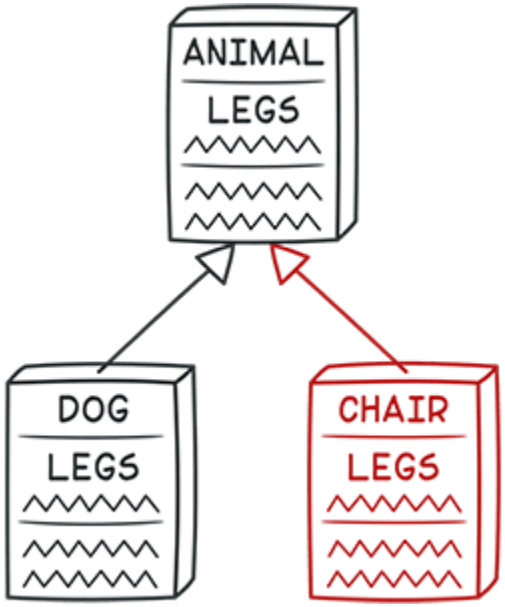
```java
abstract class Animal {
    abstract String makeSound();
}

class Cat extends Animal {
    @Override
    String makeSound() {
        return "meow";
    }
}

class Dog extends Animal {
    @Override
    String makeSound() {
        return "woof";
    }
}
```


https://www.baeldung.com/cs/code-smells

OO Abusers: **Refused bequest**



- Subclasses inherit the methods and data of their parents, but they use only a subset of the implemented parent methods. The unwanted methods may simply go unused or be redefined and throw exceptions
- Possible reason: someone was motivated to create inheritance between classes only by the desire to reuse the code in a superclass.
- Also violates the Liskov Substitution Principle.

Treatment

- **Push down method** - Remove the method or property from Base class and move it to that subclass where it fits.
- Use implementable interfaces
- If inheritance makes no sense and the subclass really does have nothing in common with the superclass, **eliminate inheritance**

OO Abusers: **Refused bequest**

Code with Refused Bequest.

```
01.  public class Vehicle
02.      {
03.          protected void Drive() { }
04.      }
05.
06.      public class Car : Vehicle
07.      {
08.      }
09.
10.      public class Plane : Vehicle
11.      {
12.      }
```



Code solving the problem of Refused Bequest.

```
01.  public class Vehicle
02.  {
03.  }
04.
05.  public class Car : Vehicle
06.  {
07.      void Drive() { }
08.  }
09.
10.  public class Plane : Vehicle
11.  {
12.  }
```

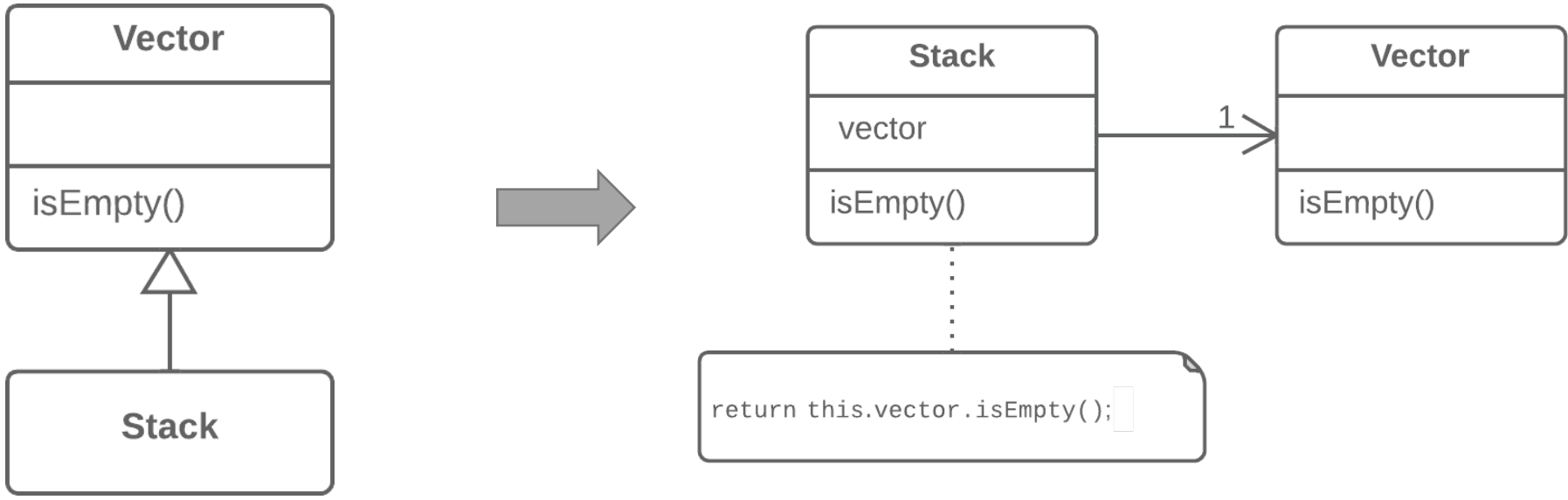
Push down method example

OO Abusers: **Refused bequest**

Remove Inheritance Example

You have a subclass that uses only a portion of the methods of its superclass (or it's not possible to inherit superclass data).

Create a field and put a superclass object in it, delegate methods to the superclass object, and get rid of inheritance.

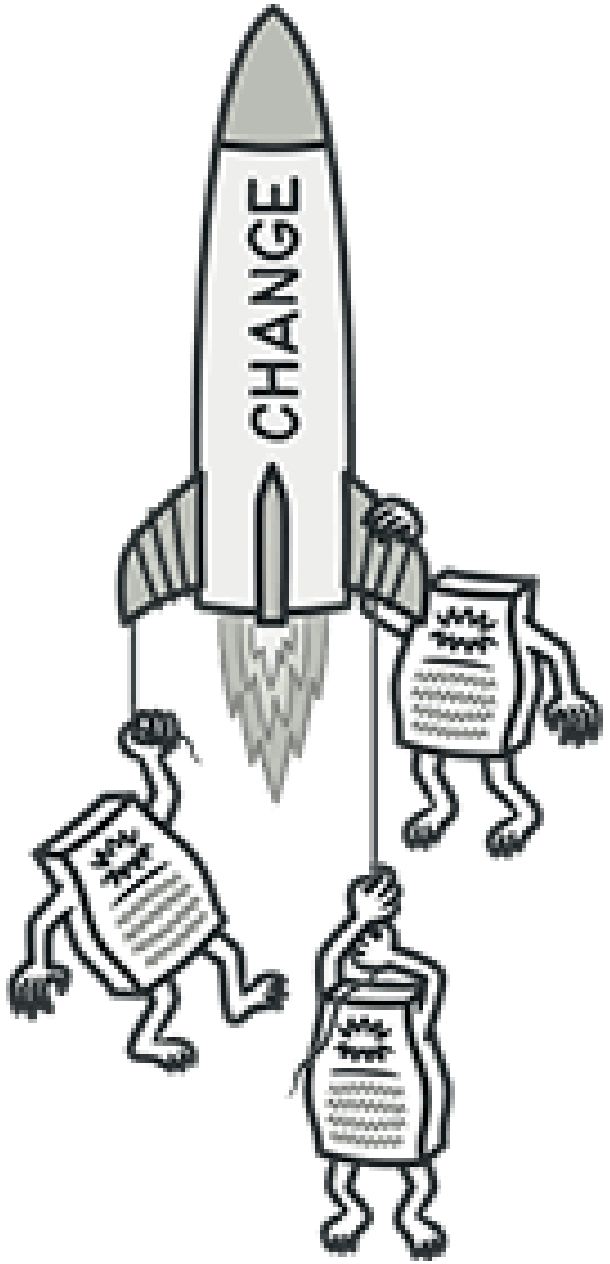


Summary: OO Abusers

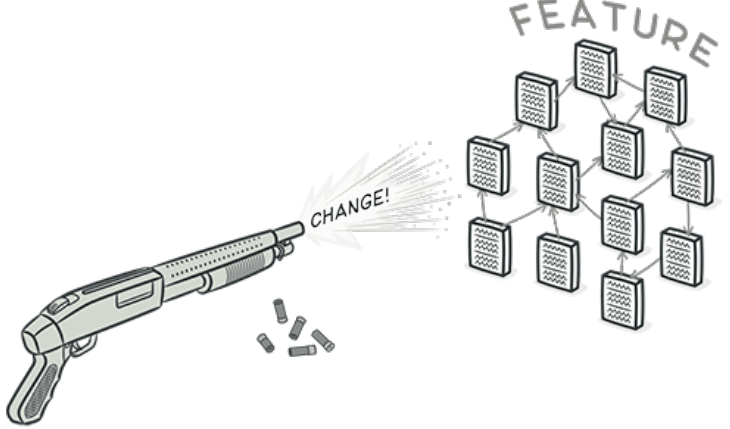
Group name	Short description	Smells in group	Treatment
Object-Orientation Abusers	cases where the solution does not fully exploit the possibilities of object-oriented design.	-Switch statements -Refused Bequest	-Use polymorphism or Extract and move method -Push down method or Eliminate inheritance or implement interfaces

Change Preventers

Shotgun Surgery & Divergent Change



Change Preventers: **Shotgun surgery**

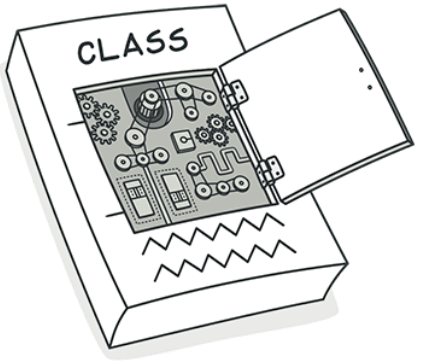


- Every time you make a modification, you must make many small changes to many classes
- Symptom that functionality is spread among classes, you have to change many classes for a small change
- Too much coupling between classes

<u>Treatment</u>

- move existing class behaviors into a single class. If there's no class appropriate for this, create a new one.

Change Preventers: **Divergent Change**



- Resembles Shotgun Surgery but is actually the opposite smell
- Divergent Change is when many changes are made to a single class. Shotgun Surgery refers to when a single change is made to many classes simultaneously.
- Possible reasons: due to poor program structure or “copypaste” programming.
- Violates High Cohesion; May violate Single Responsibility Principle

<u>Treatment</u>

- Extract Class/Method

Summary: Change Preventers

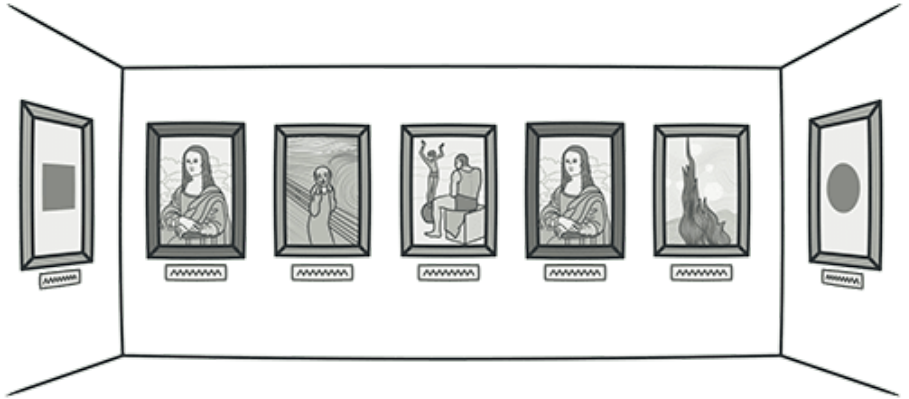
Group name	Short description	Smells in group	Treatment
Change Preventers	smells that hinder changing or further developing the software.	-Divergent Change -Shotgun surgery	-Extract Class, Method -Move methods and fields

Dispensables

Duplicated code, Lazy Classes, and Data Classes



Dispensables: **Duplicated code**



- Most common
- Sections of code repeated all over the place
- Sign of amateur work
- When refactoring duplicated code, you must effectively search for all instances of that code

<u>Treatment</u>

- Extract Method

Dispensables: **Lazy Class**



- If a class doesn’t do enough to earn your attention, it should be deleted
- Possible reasons:
  - class was designed to be fully functional but after some of the refactoring it has become ridiculously small
  - it was designed to support future development work that never got done

<u>Treatment</u>

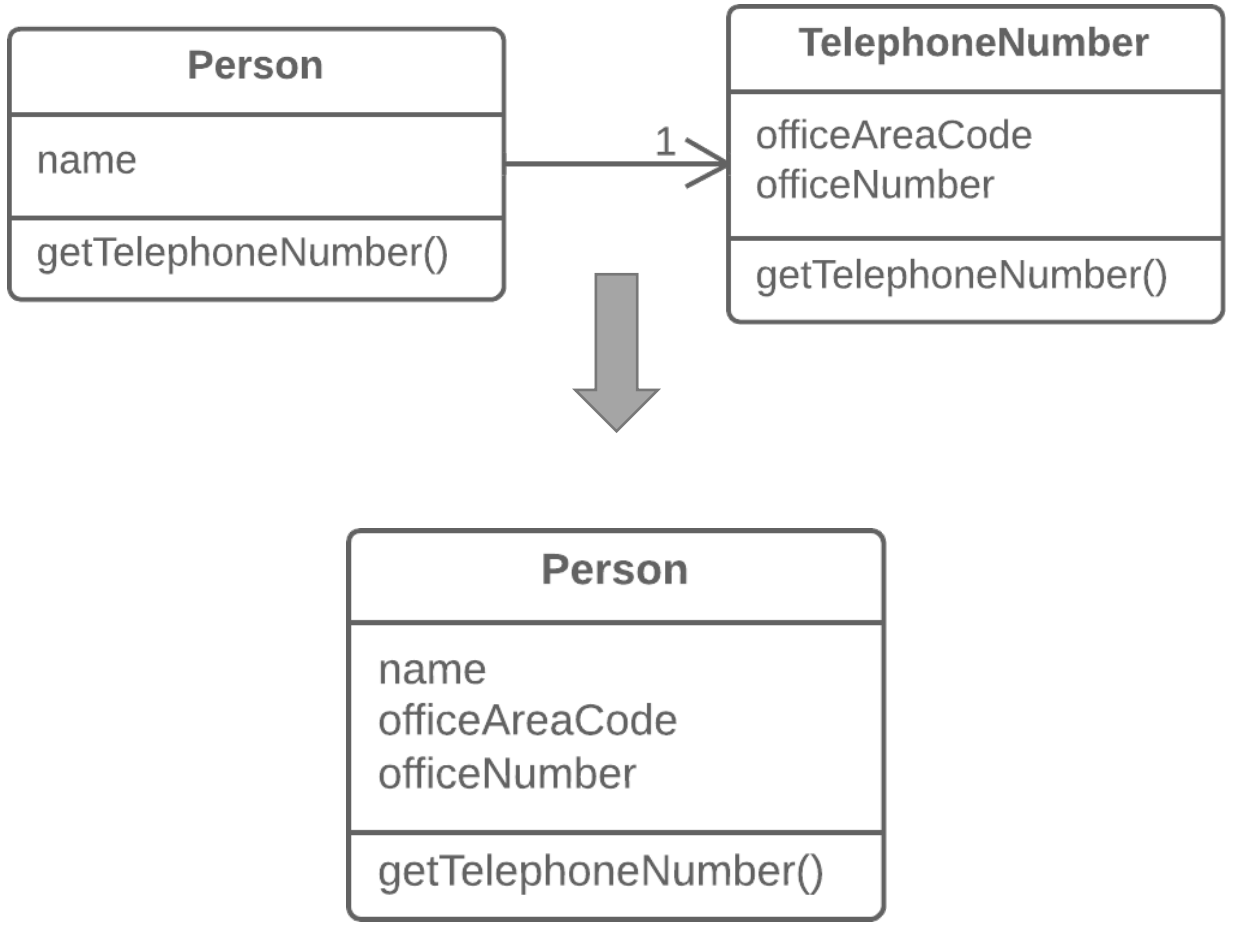
- Inline Class

Dispensables: **Lazy Class**

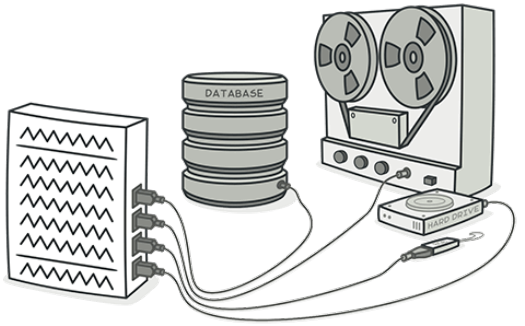


Inline Class Example

A class does almost nothing and isn't responsible for anything, and no additional responsibilities are planned for it.



Dispensables: **Data Class**



- A class that contains only fields and crude methods for accessing them (getters and setters). These are simply containers for data used by other classes.
- These classes do not contain any additional functionality and can't independently operate on their data.

Treatment

- Move method and Extract Method to move functionality to the data class
- Encapsulations – to hide from direct access and require that access be performed via getters and setters only
  - Identify methods that operate on the data you're encapsulating and consider moving them to this new class.

Summary: Dispensables

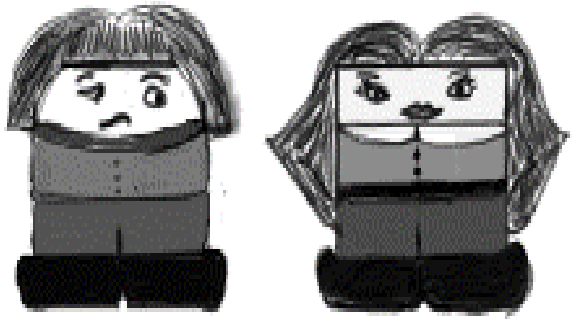
Group name	Short description	Smells in group	Treatment
Dispensables	represent something unnecessary that should be removed from the source code.	-Lazy class -Data class -Duplicated code	-Inline class -Move method/Extract Method/Encapsulation -Extract Method

Couplers

Feature envy, Inappropriate intimacy, & Middle man



Couplers: **Feature Envy**



- A method that seems more interested in a class other than the one it is in
- Most common focus of the envy is the data
- As a basic rule: if things change at the same time, you should keep them in the same place.

Treatment

- **Move Method**: determine which class has most of the data and put the method with that data

Couplers: **Feature Envy** - Example

```java
public class User {
    private ContactInfo contactInfo;
    public User(ContactInfo contactInfo) { this.contactInfo = contactInfo; }
    public String getFullAddress() {
        String streetName = contactInfo.getStreetName();
        String city = contactInfo.getCity();
        String state = contactInfo.getState();
        return streetName + ", " + city + ", " + state;
    }
}
```

What is the solution?

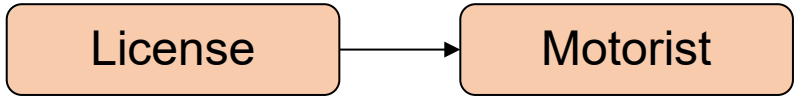
Couplers: Inappropriate Intimacy

- One class uses the internal fields and methods of another class. Classes know too much about each other
- Violating Low Coupling
- Bi-directional behavior between classes creates tight inter-dependency, i.e., classes are tightly coupled
- Good classes should know as little about each other as possible. Such classes are easier to maintain and reuse.

Treatment

- **Move Method/Move Field**: move parts of one class to the class in which those parts are used. But this works only if the first class truly doesn't need these parts.
- Change Bidirectional Association to Unidirectional

Couplers: **Inappropriate Intimacy** Example 1/2



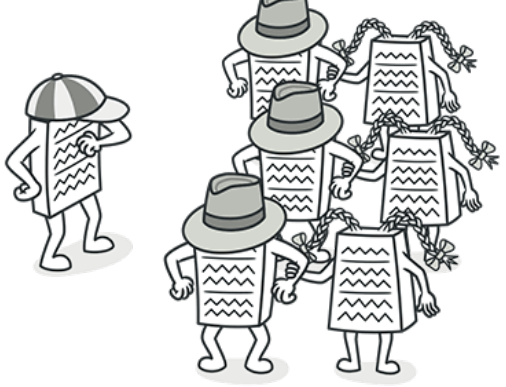

```
public class License {
    private Motorist motorist;
    private int points = 0;
    public void setMotorist(Motorist motorist) { this.motorist = motorist; }
    public int getPoints() { return points; }
    public void addPoints(int points) { this.points += points; }
    public String getSummary() {
        return motorist.getTitle() + " " + motorist.getFirstName()
                + " " + motorist.getLastName() + ", " + getPoints()
                + " points";
    }
```

Couplers: **Inappropriate Intimacy** Example 2/2




```
public class Motorist {
    private String title;
    private String firstName;
    private String lastName;
    private License license;
    public String getTitle() { return title; }
    public String getFirstName() { return firstName; }
    public String getLastName() { return lastName; }
    public RiskFactor getRiskFactor() {
        if (license.getPoints() > 3)
            return RiskFactor.HIGH_RISK;
        if (license.getPoints() > 0)
            return RiskFactor.MODERATE_RISK;
        return RiskFactor.LOW_RISK;
    }
```

Couplers: **Middle Man**



- If a class performs only one action, delegating work to another class, why does it exist at all?
- Violating SRP
- Possible reasons: it can be the result of the useful work of a class being gradually moved to other classes. The class remains as an empty shell that doesn't do anything other than delegate.

<u>Treatment</u>

- Inline Class

Summary: Couplers

Group name	Short description	Smells in group	Treatment
Couplers	a measure of how closely connected two routines or modules are	-Feature envy	-Move method/field
		-Inappropriate intimacy	-Move methods, Bidirectional to unidirectional association
		-Middle man	-Inline Class

Summary

Group name	Short description	Smells in group	Treatment
Bloaters	something that has grown so large that it cannot be effectively handled.	-Long method -Large class -Long parameter list -Data clumps	-Extract Method -Extract class -Replace parameters with method call/object - Preserve whole object
Object-Orientation Abusers	cases where the solution does not fully exploit the possibilities of object-oriented design.	-Switch statements -Refused Bequest	-Use polymorphism -Push down method -Eliminate inheritance
Change Preventers	smells that hinder changing or further developing the software.	-Divergent Change -Shotgun surgery	-Extract Class, Method -Move methods and fields
Dispensables	represent something unnecessary that should be removed from the source code.	-Lazy class -Data class -Duplicated code	-Inline class -Move method/Extract Method/Encapsulation -Extract Method
Couplers	a measure of how closely connected two routines or modules are	-Feature envy -Inappropriate intimacy -Middle man	-Move method/field -Bidirectional to unidirectional association -Inline Class

Top 10 Code Smells to Identify in PRs

https://axolo.co/blog/p/top-10-code-smells-to-identify-in-pull-requests-with-code-examples